

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Stream of Wealth

Ārya-vasudhārā-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 662 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ནོ་གུ་ཅེ་བ་བྱའི་གཟུངས།

Toh 662 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Vasudhārā-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the Phags pa nor gyi rgyun zhes bya ba'i gzungs, meaning "The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Stream of Wealth." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and takes the form of a sūtra-style discourse in which the Buddha, dwelling in the city of Kauśāmbī amid a great assembly of monks and bodhisattvas, is approached by a faithful householder named Excellent Moon. The text centers on the dhāraṇī of Vasudhārā, a deity associated with abundance and prosperity, and presents the sacred formula along with the merits and blessings conferred upon those who uphold it.

In Sanskrit: Ārya-vasudhārā-nāma-dhāraṇī. In Tibetan: The noble dhāraṇī called Stream of Wealth.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in the city of Kauṣāmbī, in the great and magnificent forest known as the Thornwood, together with a great community of monks numbering some five hundred, and with very many great bodhisattvas endowed with all the qualities of a buddha. At that time, in the great city of Kauṣāmbī, there lived a householder named Excellent Moon, whose faculties were at peace and whose mind was at peace, and who possessed many sons, daughters, and servants, and was possessed of faith, and of great faith. He went to where the Blessed One was staying, and having arrived, he bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him many hundreds of thousands of times, and sat down to one side.

Having sat to one side, the householder Excellent Moon addressed the Blessed One in these words: "If, having asked, the Blessed One — the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha — would grant me the occasion to ask, I would put certain questions to the Blessed One."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said to the householder Excellent Moon: "Householder, ask whatever you wish. By prophetically answering whatever question you pose, I shall gladden your mind."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the householder Excellent Moon said, "Excellent!" to the Blessed One, and listening respectfully to the Blessed One, he addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, how may a son or daughter of noble family who has become poor be rid of their poverty? And how, if struck by a disease of the bile, may they be rid of that disease?"

Thereupon the Blessed One, knowing full well, said to the householder Excellent Moon: "Householder, why do you ask for the sake of the poor?"

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the householder Excellent Moon replied to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I myself have many who are poor, many who are sick, and many sons and daughters and servants. For that reason, may the Blessed One please teach well the enumeration of Dharma by which poor sentient beings may be freed from poverty, those struck by disease of the bile may be freed from that disease, and beings may come to possess wealth, grain, storehouses, and many treasures; and may come to be loved, pleasing, delightful to behold, and powerful; and may be free from the need to seek out a generous patron; and may come to be abundantly possessed — without need to beg — of riches, gold, wealth, granaries and treasures, jewels, pearls, vajras, lapis lazuli, conch, crystal, coral, golden wheat, and all manner of abundance; and may the servants and retinue of the household be made stable."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said to the householder Excellent Moon: "Householder, in the past, beyond the passage of incalculable eons, at that time, there was the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, tamer of persons to be tamed, unsurpassed guide, teacher of gods and humans —

the Blessed One, the Tathāgata called Ocean-Voice of the Vajra-Bearer, appeared in this world. Son of good family, I heard this dhāraṇī called Stream of Wealth from that Tathāgata, held it, retained it, recited it, mastered it fully, rejoiced in it, and then taught it in full and in detail to others as well. Son of good family, I now teach it again.

Son of good family, by the power of this dhāraṇī, human beings will not be harmed. Non-humans will not be harmed. Yakṣas will not be harmed. Rākṣasas will not be harmed. Hungry ghosts (pretas) will not be harmed. Flesh-eaters will not be harmed. Elemental spirits will not be harmed. Pot-spirits will not be harmed. Forgetfulness-spirits will not be harmed. Oppressor-spirits will not be

harmēd. Corpse-reanimating spirits will not be harmed. Gods will not be harmed. Asuras will not be harmed. Those who feed on impurity, those who drink urine, those who drink blood, those who eat flesh, those who drink pus, those who eat fat, those who eat feet, those who eat mucus, those who drink what flows from an open wound, those who breathe in breath, and those who eat the elements — none of these will be able to do harm.

Son of good family, whichever son of good family or daughter of good family has this dhāraṇī called Stream of Wealth in their home, carries it at their heart, holds it in their hand, has it placed in a book, has heard it, has fully mastered it, has recited it, has held it, has rejoiced in it, or has taught it widely and in detail to others — upon that son of good family or daughter of good family there shall come long-lasting benefit, helpfulness, virtue, accomplishment, happiness, and an excellent harvest. Whoever makes offerings to the Tathāgatas and recites this dhāraṇī called Stream of Wealth twice, three times, or four times at midnight — the gods will be delighted, and filled with joy in the teaching of the Tathāgata, joyful that the Dharma has been proclaimed, joyful that the Saṅgha has been proclaimed, joyful in those who speak the Dharma, they will come themselves with supreme intention and send down a rain of grain.

Namo vajradhāra-sāgara-nirghoṣāya tathāgatāya. Tadyathā: oṃ surūpe bhadre bhadravati aṅgale maṅgale maṅgalavati ale acale acalavale udghaṭani udbhedani pasyavati dānapati dhanyapati śrīmati prabhavati amale vimale nirmale ruru surūve surūpamale vimale cale acanaste annaste vinnaste viśvakeśi viśvaniśi aṅkure maṅkure prabaṅkure vīrame vidhame ririme didime dudume khakhame tatara taratara tāratāra vajre vajre vajravame ṭake ṭake ṭhake ṭhake ugke bugke ṭhake ṭharake avartani varaśana ṣadani vajradhāra-sāgara-nirghaṣāna tathāgata-manusmara smara smara sarva-tathāgata-satya-manusmara dharma-satya-manusmara saṅgha-satya-manusmara data data pūra pūra pūraya pūraya pūraṇi bhara bharaṇi amale sumaṅgala śāntamati śubhamati maṅgalabhani mahāmati mahāmati bhadravati prabhavati sucandramati āgaccha āgaccha samaya-manusmara svāhā āvaraṇi-manusmara svāhā prabhava-manusmara svāhā dīdī-manusmara svāhā.

tejo-manusmara svāhā. vijaya-manusmara svāhā. hṛdaya-manusmara svāhā. sarva-sattva-vinaya-manusmara svāhā. oṃ vasuddhāre svāhā. oṃ pasuśriye svāhā. oṃ śrīvasu svāhā. oṃ vasu svāhā.

O son of good family, this is the dhāraṇī called the Stream of Wealth. By the power of this dhāraṇī mantra, famine, disease, and untimely death will not arise. O son of good family, whoever makes offerings to the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened buddhas, and recites the words of the secret mantra of the Stream of Wealth dhāraṇī for a single night — for that person the accomplishment will come to pass. For the purpose of increase, whether in one's own home or another's home, in a clean and pure treasury or in any place whatsoever, one should make a square maṇḍala of sandalwood for the Tathāgata Avalokiteśvara, all the buddhas, all the bodhisattvas, and the deities of the secret mantras, and recite it for a single night. Then, O son of good family, that person's home will be filled — to the capacity of a great household — with jewels, grain, gold, silver, and all manner of possessions. All fears and harms will likewise be entirely absent. Therefore, O son of good family, apply yourself with great diligence: hold this Stream of Wealth dhāraṇī, recite it, chant it, teach it, and teach it thoroughly and completely to others as well. This will be for your long-term benefit, welfare, and happiness.

"Excellent!" said the householder Sucandra to the Blessed One. Having heard this Stream of Wealth dhāraṇī from the Blessed One, he was satisfied, joyful, glad, and delighted — filled with great happiness — and bliss and mental ease arose in him. He bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, I have taken up what is called the Stream of Wealth. I have received it in the dhāraṇī. I have grasped it, recited it, thoroughly mastered it, and rejoiced in it. And I will teach it widely and thoroughly to others as well."

At that very instant, the storehouses of the householder Sucandra were completely filled. Then the householder Sucandra circumambulated the Blessed One many hundreds of thousands of times, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and departed from the Blessed One's presence.

Then the Blessed One said to the Venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, go and look upon the home of the householder Sucandra — abundant with wealth and grain, perfectly complete — and upon his great treasury and the storehouses filled to the full."

Then the Venerable Ānanda, heeding the Blessed One's words, set out toward the great city of Kauśāmbī and toward the home of the householder Sucandra. Upon arriving and entering within, he saw that it was filled with abundant wealth and grain, perfectly complete, with precious jewels in abundance, a

great treasury of all manner of possessions, and storehouses entirely full. Seeing this, he was satisfied, joyful, glad, and delighted — great happiness arose in him, and bliss and mental ease were born — and he went to where the Blessed One was.

Then the Venerable Ānanda, astonished and filled with joy and mental ease, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what is the cause and what is the condition by which the householder Sucandra, who is so rich in wealth, now has great treasures and storehouses so abundantly filled with wealth and grain?"

The Blessed One replied: "Ānanda, this son of good family, the householder Sucandra, with faith, with supreme faith, and with wholesome intention, has taken hold of this Stream of Wealth dhāraṇī and thoroughly recited it.

taken hold of it, thoroughly recited it, brought it to complete perfection, rejoiced in it himself, and taught it extensively and correctly to others. Therefore, Ānanda, you too should receive this Stream of Wealth dhāraṇī, cherish it, learn it, teach it, hold it, bring it to complete perfection, and teach it extensively and correctly to others. For it will be for the benefit of the many, for the happiness of the many, out of compassion for the world, and for the good, the benefit, and the happiness of the great multitude of people, of gods, and of humans.

Ānanda, as for anyone who would speak differently from what this vidyā-mantra declares — I have not seen in all the world, with its gods, its māras, its Brahmās, its ascetics and brahmins, its gods, humans, and asuras, even one who could refute it when it is recited a second time or a third time. That is simply impossible.

Ānanda, the words of this dhāraṇī-mantra are inviolable. Ānanda, if even the sound of these words does not reach the ears of sentient beings whose roots of virtue have been exhausted, what need is there to speak of writing them in a book or holding them in mind? And why is this? Because all the Tathāgatas have proclaimed it. This dhāraṇī-mantra was spoken, expounded, rejoiced in, analyzed, praised, elucidated, illuminated, generated, blessed, sealed with the Dharma mudrā, extolled, beautifully expressed, made comprehensible, and commended by all the Tathāgatas — for the sake of all sentient beings who are impoverished, tormented by manifold illness, threatened by fear, and harmed by the enmity of other beings.

Then the Venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, joined his palms together, and uttered this solemn declaration in verse:

The Buddha, the Blessed One, is inconceivable,
and the Buddha's Dharma too is inconceivable.
For those who have faith in what is inconceivable,
the karmic maturation is also inconceivable.

Peaceful, omniscient, knowing all things,
King of the Dharma, free from old age and death,
gone to the far shore of primordial wisdom —
O Buddha, O hero, to you I bow.

Then the Venerable Ānanda, satisfied, joyful, delighted, and rejoicing, filled with joy and mental ease, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what is the name of this presentation of the Dharma, and how should it be held?"

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, hold it as 'Requested by the Householder Sucandra.' Hold it also as 'Treasury of All Wealth, Grain, and Precious Things.' And hold it as well as 'The Stream of Wealth dhāraṇī, Praised by All the Tathāgatas.'"

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the Venerable Ānanda, those monks, those bodhisattvas, the entire assembly gathered there, and the gods, humans, asuras,

Translator's Notes

- The title Ārya-vasudhārā-nāma-dhāraṇī renders the Tibetan "noble dhāraṇī called Stream of Wealth," where vasu means wealth and dhārā means stream or flow. This is the canonical dhāraṇī of the goddess Vasudhārā, a deity of abundance, though she is not yet named at this point in the text.

The epithet string at the text's close — "endowed with knowledge and conduct" — renders rig pa dang zabs su ldan pa, the standard Tibetan for the Sanskrit vidyācaraṇasampanna, one of the ten epithets of a buddha. The passage breaks off mid-sentence in the source, and the translation faithfully reflects that open ending.

The phrase rendered "disease of the bile" translates bro nad, a bilious or jaundice-related illness in Tibetan medical terminology, here used both literally and as an example of physical affliction that the dhāraṇī is said to alleviate.

- The long catalogue of spirit-classes that "will not be harmed" uses a passive construction in Tibetan; the more natural English rendering in protective dhāraṇī literature is "will not be able to harm," but the Tibetan literally says they will not harm or harass — both readings are defensible. The rendering chosen preserves ambiguity.

The mantra text is transliterated directly from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit; individual syllables reflect the Tibetan orthographic conventions for Sanskrit and may diverge slightly from any reconstructed Sanskrit original. No attempt has been made to normalise or emend the mantra, as dhāraṇī texts are transmitted as received.

- The epithet Avalokiteśvara appears here in a somewhat unusual syntactic position — listed alongside "the Tathāgata" — which may reflect a specific local tradition or a slight irregularity in the Tibetan source text. No emendation has been made; the text is rendered as it stands.

The city name Kauśāmbī is transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering ཀཤམ་བོ།.

- * The passage contains a list of verbs describing how the Tathāgatas have treated this dhāraṇī,** rendered as a flowing English series. The Tibetan བཤོད་གྲངས་བརྒྱན་པའི་མཚན་ལྟར།, literally "sealed with the Dharma seal," is rendered "sealed with the Dharma mudrā" to preserve the technical character of the term. The verse is genuine verse in Tibetan and is presented accordingly.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.